

Somatic Release

Clearing what's stored · The body entry point

WHO THIS IS FOR

You feel things physically before you can name them. Tight jaw. Shoulders near your ears. You may have done the thinking work — and still carry it. Somatic release works below the level of narrative.

■ MORNING — 20 MIN

1 Sunlight exposure

5 min

Outside within 30 min of waking. No sunglasses.

2 Body awareness scan

5 min

Notice physical sensation only — not what it means.

3 Neurogenic shaking

5-10 min

Standing, knees soft. Let the tremor arise. Follow it — do not force it.

THROUGHOUT THE DAY

4 Interoception check-ins

30 sec × 4

"What am I sensing?" Name one sensation — not an emotion.

■ EVENING — 20 MIN

5 TRE or PMR

15-20 min

TRE preferred (neurogenic tremoring). PMR on non-TRE evenings.

6 Extended exhale

5 min

4 sec in / 6-8 sec out. Parasympathetic activation. Day is done.

Sleep foundation

7–9 hours · consistent timing · dark and cool

WEEKLY ADDITIONS

Full TRE session

3x/week

All 7 exercises + tremoring

20 min

Expressive writing

3x/week

Pennebaker protocol

20 min

Zone 2 cardio

3x/week

Talk-test intensity

30-45 min

Somatic movement

2x/week

Yoga, tai chi, free movement

30 min

Nature walk

3x/week

No headphones

30 min

Weekly body check-in

1x/week

What was the body doing?

10 min

WHAT TO EXPECT

Weeks 1-2

Tremoring unfamiliar. Normal.

Weeks 3-4

Body signalling more clearly.

Weeks 5-8

Tension patterns changing.

Week 8+

Body talking, not just holding.

Somatic Release

Clearing what's stored · The body entry point

PRACTICE INSTRUCTIONS

1. Body awareness scan

5 min · morning

Seated or lying, eyes closed. Begin at the feet — temperature, pressure, tingling, or nothing. Move slowly upward. Goal: not relaxation, but accurate reading. Anxious nervous systems often misread physical signals as threats. The scan rebuilds the map. Note where you feel nothing — numbness is also information.

2. Neurogenic shaking

5-10 min · morning

Stand feet shoulder-width apart. Soften the knees. Let weight drop through the hips. You may feel subtle vibration in the legs. Allow it — don't force it. The tremoring is the natural neurogenic discharge, the same mechanism other mammals use after incomplete stress responses. If nothing arises, gently bounce the knees softly.

3. Interoception check-ins

30 sec × 4 · through day

Four times daily: "What am I sensing in my body right now?" Name one physical sensation — not "I'm anxious" (interpretation), but: tightness in the chest, warmth behind the eyes, heaviness in the shoulders. Over weeks this builds the vocabulary of interoceptive reading, the foundation of somatic regulation.

4. TRE — seven exercises

15-20 min · evening

Exercises that fatigue specific leg and hip muscles, then invite neurogenic tremoring: (1) Wall sit 2 min; (2) hip circles; (3) bent-knee forward fold; (4) inner thigh stretch; (5) bridge; (6) knees falling out in bridge; (7) butterfly — soles together, knees out. In this final position fatigued muscles tremble. Allow 10-15 minutes. Rest flat after.

5. Progressive muscle relaxation

non-TRE evenings

Lie down. Work through each muscle group: feet, calves, thighs, glutes, abdomen, hands, forearms, shoulders, face. For each: tense deliberately 5-7 seconds — firmly, not painfully. Then release completely. Notice the contrast 20-30 seconds before moving on. PMR: voluntary tension-release. TRE: involuntary tremoring. Alternate through the week.

6. Expressive writing

20 min · 3x weekly

Set a timer for 20 minutes. Write continuously about an emotionally significant experience. The Pennebaker protocol: write your deepest thoughts and feelings — not just events, but what they meant and how they connect to the rest of your life. Same experience for 3-4 sessions. It may feel worse before better. That's the processing.

7. Extended exhale

5 min · evening

Inhale 4 seconds, exhale 6-8 seconds. In the somatic context the extended exhale is the breath's surrender equivalent — releasing control of the out-breath mirrors releasing physical holding in the body. Pairs naturally with TRE or PMR as the evening's final step.